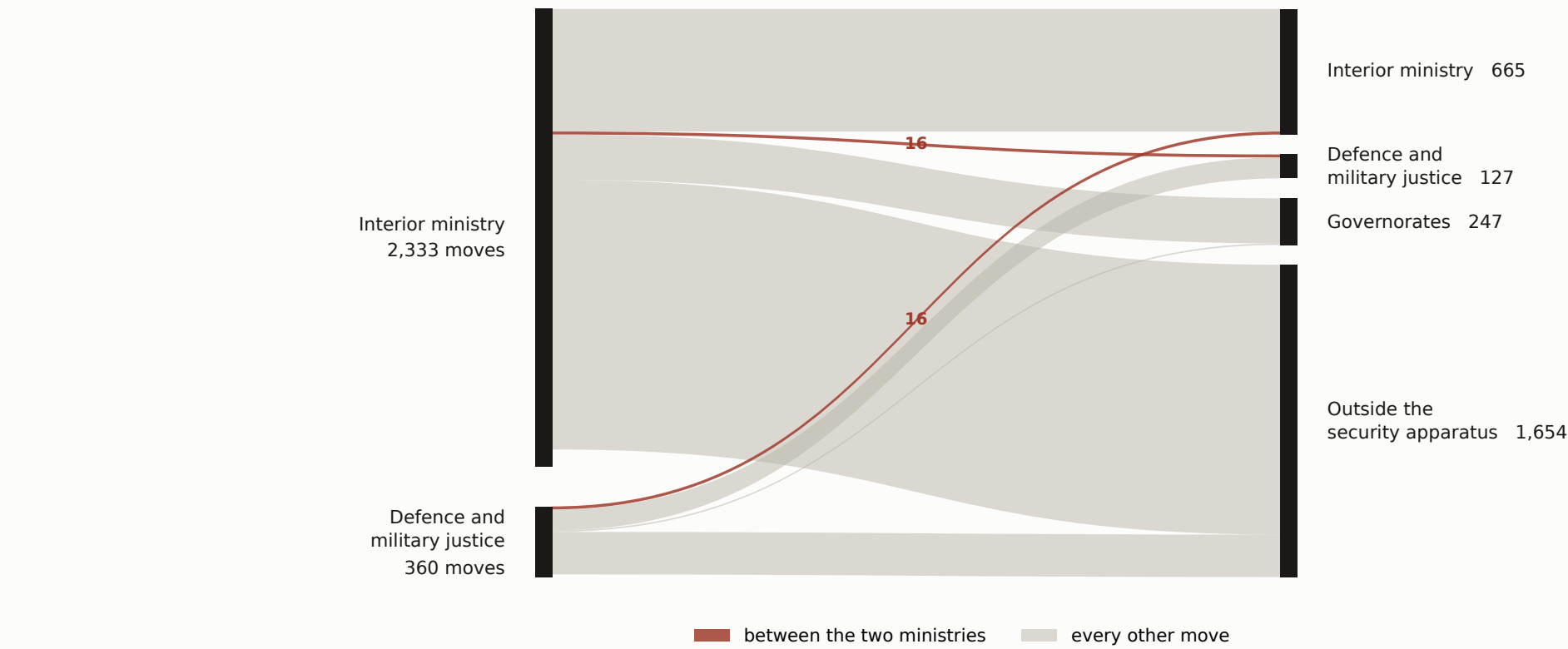


The interior and defence ministries barely exchange anyone

Every consecutive move made by someone holding a post in one of the two ministries, across the whole record, 1957-2026. Of 2,333 moves out of an interior post, 16 go to defence; of 360 out of a defence post, 16 go to the interior. That is 0.7% and 4.4% — 27 people in sixty-nine years, 5 of whom crossed in both directions. Both ministries recruit their next officeholder from themselves or from outside the security apparatus altogether, and almost never from each other.



Source: Journal Officiel de la République Tunisienne, 1957-2026 (6,378 French issues, jort.tn). Author's extraction. Both ministries are drawn on one scale, so the defence column's height is its share of the two ministries' moves and not a separate diagram: that relative size is part of what is shown. This is the one flow figure in the set not drawn per rupture, because the five-year windows around the three ruptures contain 0 and 0 crossings for 1987, 1 and 1 for 2011, and 2 and 3 for 2021 — six panels on that would set a ribbon of one person beside a ribbon of hundreds and invite the comparison. Colour marks the flow the figure is about against all others; it carries no category. A move is one post to the next by start date, a person holding several posts placed at the highest, so a spell that ends with no further gazetted post does not appear — the gazette records appointments far better than departures. Defence here is the ministry, the military tribunals and the army by name, plus any body whose portfolio names defence, which is the test the security-branch figure already uses. Widening it to every body with 'militaire' in its name — the military hospitals, the housing office, the research centre — adds 62 spells and takes defence-to-interior from 16 to 20, leaving interior-to-defence at 16. The narrow test is kept because much of what widening adds is board seats held by other ministries' representatives, where the officeholder is a domains or finance official rather than a defence one. The conclusion is the same either way.